

Debut century: Wriddhiman Saha and a young Virat Kohli stitched a 114-run stand before Virat got to his first Test hundred in the fourth Test of the series against Australia in Adelaide in 2012. K. R. DEEPAK



strength.”

The duo stitched a 114-run stand. Saha made 35. Kohli stood tall with a gritty 116 off 213 balls.

“He was someone who’s always positive and could pass on that positivity to everyone around him,” Saha said. That quality reflected in Kohli’s captaincy from 2015 to 2021.

“A lot of us were perhaps a bit shy in showing our emotions, but that was never the case with Virat. Since his U-19 days, he showed the world what he was capable of. But to maintain that same level of energy and aggression at the highest level — that takes something else,” Saha added.

“The fact that he could look the opponent in the eye and never give up made him what he is. Even broadcasters preferred showing his expressions after every wicket — those animated reactions captured how passionate he was about the game.”

Saha admitted Kohli drew from Mahendra Singh Dhoni’s leadership but forged his own style.

“He took inspiration from Mahi bhai, but he was a different



captain,” he said.

Saha also praised Kohli’s practice ethic.

“I have never seen Virat taking things easy during practice. Be it a preparatory camp or a match simulation, he was always

well-prepared — often the first to arrive and last to leave. He worked in every department and focused particularly on fitness. The only other name that comes to mind is Jonty Rhodes,” he said.

Fast bowler **Ishant Sharma**, (Left) Kohli’s longtime friend from Delhi cricket circles, pointed to a lesser-seen side of the star.

“Imagine your brother has reached such heights. Everyone thinks he’s great. But at the end of the day, he’s a human being. We’ve spent time together, shared rooms. I have never felt that he is Virat Kohli. For us, he is Cheeku,” Ishant said on *Star Sports Press Room*.

Kohli’s decision to step away from the longest format has sparked debate. Some feel he should have played the England series. But those who’ve followed him closely believe he exited on his own terms — after an incredible run.